# **Country Summary:** New Zealand



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*Executive summary of the New Zealand country profile (2026-10-21). Superscript numbers refer to the numbered sources in New Zealand_Profile_DRAFT_SOURCES.docx.*

# At a Glance

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **5.36 m**<br>Population, 30 June 2026, provisional[3] | **57,350**<br>GDP per capita, PPP (international dollars), about, 2025[6] | **10.06%**<br>Current health expenditure, share of GDP, 2024[37] | **12.7%**<br>Out-of-pocket share of current health expenditure, 2024[39] |
| **3.61**<br>Physicians per 1,000 people, 2022[43] | **82.0**<br>Life expectancy at birth, years, 2024[14] | **17.6%**<br>Population aged 65 and over, 2025[12] | **NZ$34.2 bn (US$19.4 bn)**<br>Total health spending, 2026/27, government figure[19] |

### Country background

New Zealand, a constitutional monarchy with its capital in Wellington, had about 5.36 million people at 30 June 2026 (provisional).[1,3,7] Governor-General Dame Cindy Kiro represents the King, and Prime Minister Christopher Luxon leads a National, ACT and New Zealand First government.[8,9] Simeon Brown is Minister of Health, and Health New Zealand has delivered public services nationally since 2022.[16,19] The high-income economy grew 1.7 percent in the year ended June 2026, and GDP per person was about 57,350 international dollars (PPP) in 2025.[6,20] The population is aging: 17.6 percent were 65 or older in 2025, and life expectancy was 82.0 years in 2024.[12,14] The key risk is fiscal, because the Treasury warns that demographic change, unless checked, will make the long-term fiscal position unsustainable.[21]

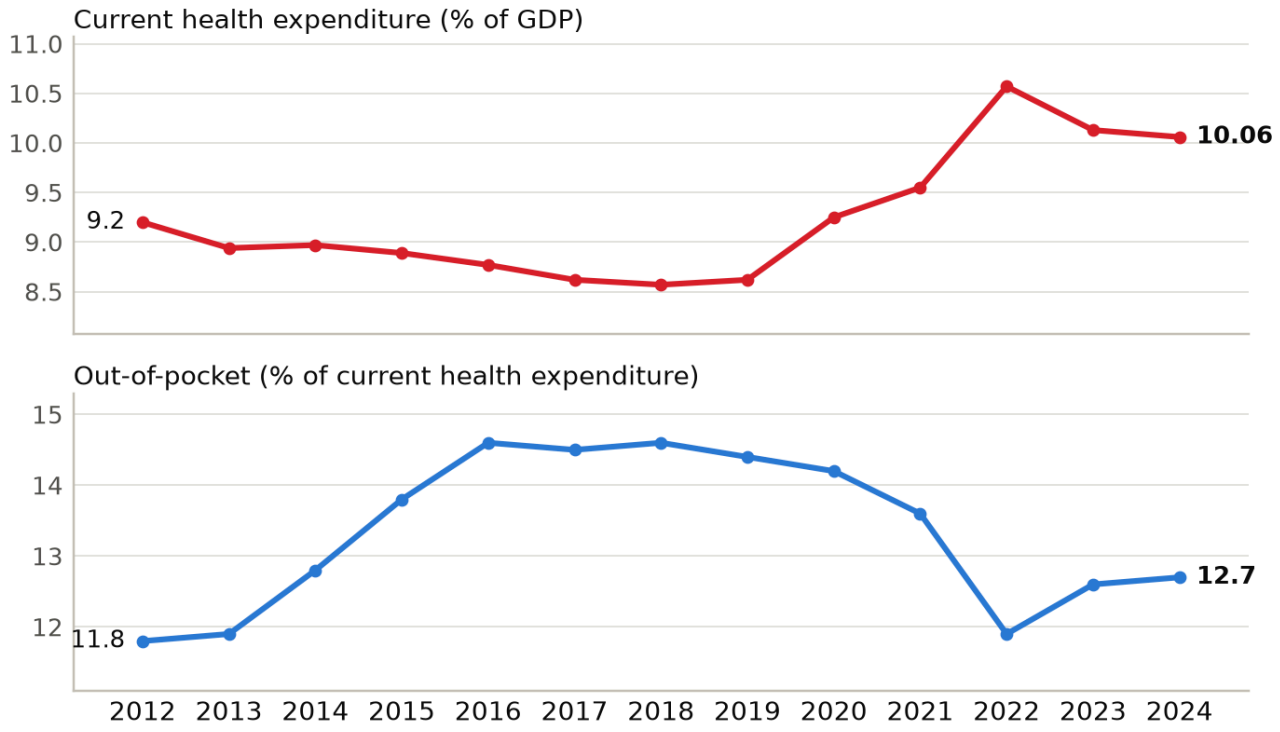
### Key takeaways for CSI

- Health spending reached 10.1 percent of GDP in 2024, from 9.2 percent in 2012.[37]
- International graduates were 43.5 percent of registered doctors in 2025, but only 40 percent stay two years.[42]
- In 2024/25, 34.2 percent of adults were obese and 14.3 percent reported high or very high psychological distress.[26]
- In 2026 Health New Zealand signed its first long-term private hospital contracts, worth about $300 million (US$170 million).[36]

# Health System

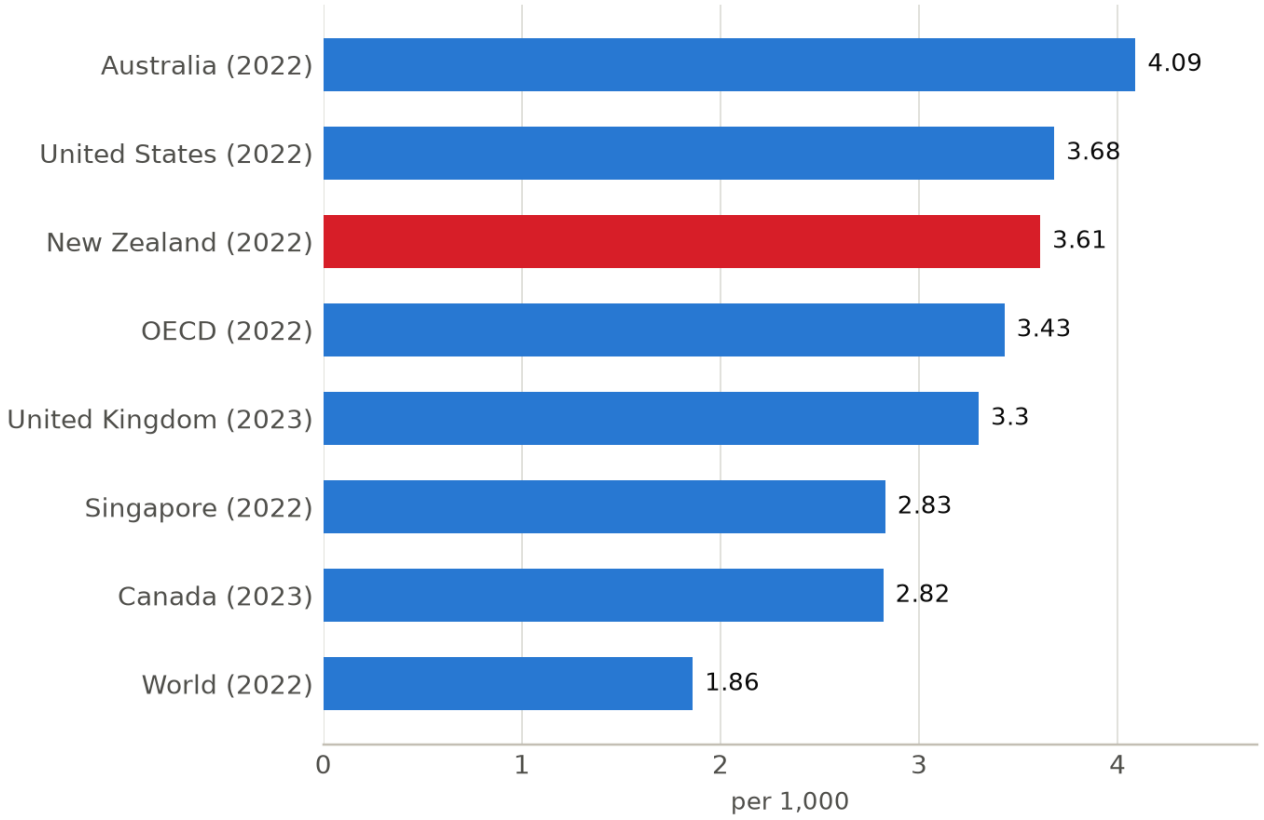
- Health New Zealand replaced the district health boards in 2022 and delivers tax-funded universal care nationally.[16]
- Elective treatment within four months reached 72.6 percent in 2025/26, up from 63.9 percent.[30]
- In 2024/25, cost stopped 14.9 percent of adults visiting a GP, and 25.5 percent cited appointment waits.[26]

**New Zealand: health spending and out-of-pocket share, 2012 to 2024**




Current health expenditure as a share of GDP, and out-of-pocket spending as a share of current health expenditure. Sources: [37,39]

**Physicians per 1,000 people, New Zealand and comparators (latest year available)**

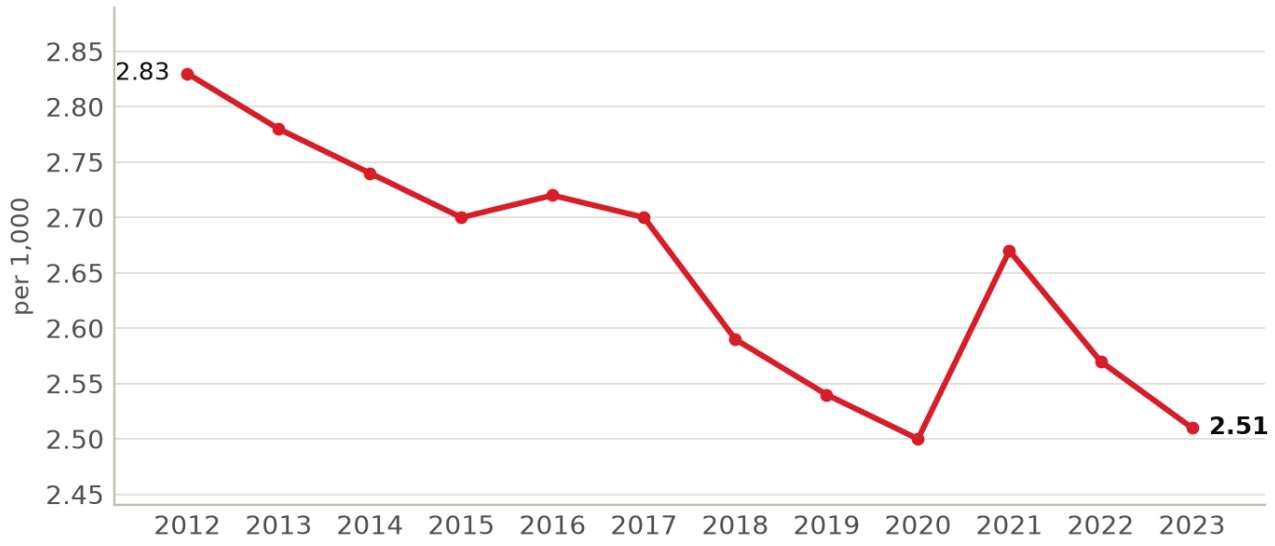



Latest year available for each country in the World Bank series, shown in brackets; comparison years differ (2022 and 2023). Sources: [47]

# Market and Competition

- About 37 percent of people hold private insurance, and Southern Cross has about 60 percent of the market.[16,31]
- Icon Oncology Group runs Wellington's Bowen Icon Cancer Centre with Australian-owned Evolution Healthcare.[34,53]
- Health New Zealand signed a digital and AI innovation agreement with London's UCLPartners in July 2026.[56]

**New Zealand: hospital beds per 1,000 people, 2012 to 2023**




Hospital beds as reported to the World Bank; 2023 is the latest year in the series. Sources: [46]

**Foreign health systems active in New Zealand**

8 foreign institutions with confirmed active partnerships (8 in all): 4 research collaboration, 2 training and education, 1 ownership or management, 1 advisory and consulting. Sources in the profile and the partnerships tracker.


2
Auckland
2 active
Tauranga
none found
Hamilton
1
1 active
3
Wellington
3 active
Christchurch
none found
2
Dunedin
2 active
Active partnerships (number in circle)
Major metro

*Active foreign health-system partnerships by city of the partner in New Zealand. Source: CSI partnerships tracker, verified 2026-10-21. Boundaries: Natural Earth; not an official depiction.*

| Institution | Nature of collaboration |
|---|---|
| **Johns Hopkins University (Bloomberg School of Public Health, Center for Indigenous Health)** | Research collaboration |
| **Icon Oncology Group (Icon Group)** | Ownership or management |
| **National University of Singapore and National University Health System** | Research collaboration |
| **UCLPartners** | Advisory and consulting |
| **Universitas Indonesia (Faculty of Public Health)** | Training and education |
| **University of Southampton (MRC Lifecourse Epidemiology Centre, EpiGen Global Research Consortium)** | Research collaboration |
| **University of Wollongong (Graduate School of Medicine)** | Training and education |
| **West Visayas State University** | Research collaboration |

# CSI Position, Risks and Recent News

### CSI partnerships in New Zealand

**[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]**

*To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.*

### Opportunities for CSI

**[MANUAL INPUT REQUIRED]**

*To be completed by CSI from internal data; not researched.*

### Risks and watch items

- A general election is due on 7 November 2026.[9] Its result will shape private outsourcing of elective surgery.
- The Treasury expects superannuation and finance costs to take about 28 percent of tax revenue by 2030/31.[21]
- Practicing nurses fell 4 percent to 80,960 at 30 June 2026, and 43.5 percent qualified overseas.[45]

### Recent developments

**2026-04-16** Mark Darrow became Health New Zealand board chair on 1 May 2026 for three years, replacing Lester Levy.[28]

**2026-05-28** Budget 2026 added more than $5.8 billion (US$3.29 billion) in new health operating funding, including a $1.37 billion (US$778 million) annual uplift.[19]

**2026-10** Health New Zealand reported 87.0 percent of cancer patients treated within 31 days of the treatment decision in 2025/26.[30]